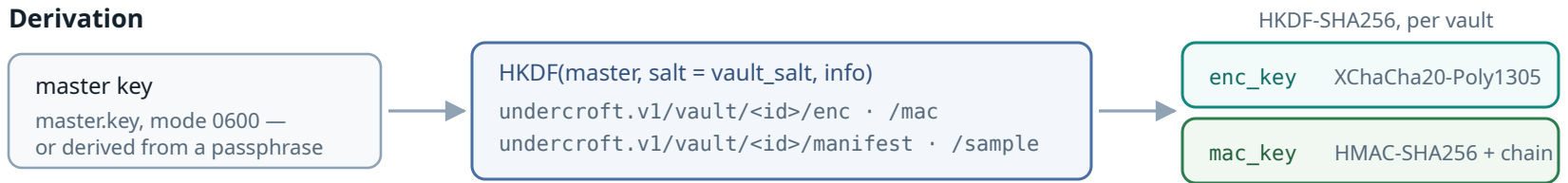


One master key, a separate key per vault, and an AAD that names the row

Isolation is cryptographic, not a WHERE clause: a blob lifted from one vault into another does not decrypt, because the vault id is authenticated.

Derivation



Four subkeys, independent outputs of one derivation: enc seals, mac tags records and the chain (and keys the dedup fingerprints), manifest MACs the rollback anchor, sample draws the training rows — so a tag can never be forged from a decryption key. All live in a zeroize-on-drop wrapper, are never Debug-printed, and the key file is fsynced at creation; a keycheck marker refuses a wrong passphrase up front rather than as a wall of decryption failures. The graph's blind-index secret is NOT derived: 32 random bytes sealed in meta, re-sealed by rotation, never regenerated — or every fact id would move.

What every sealed blob authenticates alongside itself

The AEAD's associated data is not decoration — it is what makes a ciphertext meaningful only in the exact position it was written.

AAD = vault id + record id + domain

<drawer id>	content
<drawer id>/emb	embedding
<drawer id>/tok	ColBERT token matrix
fde/<drawer id>/tok	FDE row
pgrow/.../pq · pq/...	PQ rows, pages, codebooks — index ids, not draw

so all of these FAIL, not merely return nothing

A blob copied from vault A into vault B — the id differs.

A row's ciphertext moved onto another row — the record id differs.

An embedding swapped in where content was expected — the domain suffix differs.

Rotation — a new key, the same history

Every artifact is decrypted under the old key and re-sealed under the new one in a **single transaction**, and the chain is re-keyed over the audit bytes it already had — the history is preserved, not restarted.

The manifest is staged as vault.json.next and swapped, so a crash mid-rotation leaves one of two consistent states and is reconciled at the next open.

Sharing — an export bundle for one recipient

Hybrid X25519 + ML-KEM-768 to the recipient's public key, both shared secrets through HKDF into XChaCha20-Poly1305. The sender's vault keys never leave the machine, the bundle is readable by exactly one holder of the matching secret, and a hybrid recipient never silently downgrades to the curve half alone.

This is the no-lock-in path: a vault can be handed over whole without ever exposing it to the operator moving it.

Where the boundary honestly sits

Sealing protects data at rest. A running process holds the derived keys in memory, so an attacker with live access to the process, or an operator hosting the engine, is inside the boundary — no at-rest scheme changes that, and claiming otherwise would be dishonest.

What it does buy, precisely: a stolen disk, a leaked backup, a snapshot, a decommissioned drive, or a copied database file yields ciphertext and the metadata inventory — never the words.

The remote index tier is treated as **untrusted** on the same reasoning: only sealed payloads are pushed to it, and anything it returns is re-verified locally against the vault's own HMAC before a single byte reaches the caller. An accelerator is not a source of truth.